

## Second Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Secunda Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: charity embodied in the banquet of God

| Proper    | TLM text / reference                                    | Scriptural axis                                   | Fathers and saints                                                    | Connection                                                                                                 |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Introit   | <i>Factus est Dominus protector meus</i> (Ps. 17)       | Rescue into breadth                               | St. Ambrose on the Psalms; Cassiodorus on Psalm 17                    | The Lord does not merely defend; he brings the soul into the wide place of divine charity.                 |
| Collect   | Fear and love of the holy Name                          | Holy fear and stable love                         | St. Bernard on the Name of Jesus; St. Catherine of Siena on holy fear | The prayer joins reverence and intimacy: fear keeps love from presumption, love keeps fear from servility. |
| Epistle   | 1 John 3:13-18                                          | Passing from death to life by loving the brethren | St. Augustine, Homilies on 1 John; St. John Chrysostom on almsgiving  | Charity must leave the tongue and enter work and truth.                                                    |
| Gospel    | Luke 14:16-24                                           | The great supper                                  | St. Gregory the Great, Gospel homilies; St. Bede on Luke              | Excuses reveal disordered loves; the poor and broken reveal the gratuitous wideness of the invitation.     |
| Offertory | <i>Domine, convertere, et eripe animam meam</i> (Ps. 6) | Conversion before communion                       | Desert Fathers on compunction                                         | The banquet is entered by being turned around, not by self-justification.                                  |
| Communion | <i>Cantabo Domino, qui bona tribuit mihi</i> (Ps. 12)   | Thanksgiving for benefits                         | St. Ignatius of Loyola, gratitude as root of service                  | The communicant sings because the supper is already gift before it is task.                                |

## Four Senses of Scripture

| Thread             | Synthesis                                                                                                                                                         |
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| <b>Literal</b>     | Luke 14 presents a man making a great supper, the invited guests refusing through excuses, and the poor and wounded being brought in.                             |
| <b>Allegorical</b> | The supper signifies the Kingdom and the Eucharistic banquet of the Church, where Israel's call opens into the gathering of the nations and the spiritually poor. |
| <b>Moral</b>       | The hearer must examine respectable attachments that make him refuse grace, then prove charity in deed and truth as 1 John commands.                              |
| <b>Anagogical</b>  | The earthly invitation anticipates the eternal wedding feast, where every excuse will be exposed and every healed poverty will become joy.                        |

## Patristic Exegesis of the Grouped Propers

The Church groups rescue, holy fear, brotherly charity, the great supper, conversion, and thanksgiving in order to interpret the Eucharistic invitation. Patristic exegesis reads Luke's banquet not as a pleasant image of religion, but as the crisis of grace: the invited refuse because their loves are disordered, while the poor enter because they have nothing with which to bargain. First John then supplies the test of whether the invitation has been accepted: love must become deed and truth.

| Thread                                    | Synthesis                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
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| <b>Introit: Psalm 17</b>                  | Ambrose and Cassiodorus read rescue from enemies as the soul being brought out of constriction into divine spaciousness. This prepares the Gospel: the banquet hall is wide, but the soul narrowed by attachment cannot enter freely.                            |
| <b>Collect: fear and love of the Name</b> | Bernard's devotion to the holy Name and the monastic tradition join reverence with affection. The Collect guards the banquet from two errors: servile fear that stays away and presumption that comes without conversion.                                        |
| <b>Epistle: 1 John 3</b>                  | Augustine reads passing from death to life as the passage into charity; hatred is a death still present in the religious man. The Church places this before Luke so that the hearer cannot treat the supper as private consolation while neglecting the brother. |
| <b>Gospel: Luke 14</b>                    | Gregory the Great reads the excuses as lawful earthly goods made obstacles by disordered love. Bede sees the poor, maimed, blind, and lame as those who know their need and can be healed by grace.                                                              |
| <b>Offertory: Psalm 6</b>                 | Patristic penitential reading hears a soul asking to be turned and delivered. After the refused banquet, the Offertory gives the correct response: not excuse, but conversion.                                                                                   |
| <b>Communion: Psalm 12</b>                | Thanksgiving for benefits completes the movement. The communicant sings not because he has earned the supper, but because he has been rescued, invited, converted, and fed.                                                                                      |

| Thread                        | Synthesis                                                                                                                                                                                              |
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| <b>Invitation and charity</b> | Luke reveals the open table; 1 John reveals the necessary fruit. The faithful are taught that Eucharistic communion and practical mercy cannot be separated.                                           |
| <b>Goods and excuses</b>      | Land, oxen, and marriage are not condemned as evil. Gregory's line of interpretation exposes how ordinary goods become refusals when they outrank the call of God.                                     |
| <b>Poverty and readiness</b>  | The poor enter because need has made them receptive. The Church's grouping instructs the faithful to approach Mass as beggars, not as patrons accepting an honor.                                      |
| <b>Conversion and song</b>    | The Offertory asks deliverance before Communion sings gratitude. Liturgically, the Church trains the hearer to move from compunction to thanksgiving.                                                  |
| <b>Church's instruction</b>   | The faithful are being told: God has widened the place of salvation, but only charity proves that one has truly entered the supper. Every respectable excuse must be judged by love in deed and truth. |

## Exegetical Notes

- Luke 14 is spoken at table. Christ turns an ordinary meal into an image of the Kingdom and of Eucharistic readiness.
- The excuses are not gross sins. Land, oxen, and marriage are legitimate goods made ultimate.
- The servant's mission widens in stages: invited guests, city streets, then roads and hedges. Grace presses outward.

| Witness               | Short text                                                     | Homiletic use                                                                                                    |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| St. Augustine         | “Love, and do what thou wilt.” Homily on 1 John                | Explain carefully: Augustine means rightly ordered charity fulfills action, not that impulse replaces obedience. |
| St. Gregory the Great | The poor brought to supper show those whom the proud overlook. | Use Gregory to expose respectable refusals and to honor the hidden guests of God.                                |
| St. John Chrysostom   | Almsgiving is a concrete test of love for Christ.              | Tie the Epistle’s “deed and truth” to parish works of mercy.                                                     |
| St. Benedict          | Prefer nothing to the love of Christ.                          | The good things named in the excuses must remain below the supreme good.                                         |

| Thread                         | Synthesis                                                                                                                                |
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| <b>Banquet and almsgiving</b>  | The Epistle tests the Gospel. One cannot accept the invitation to the great supper while closing the heart to a needy brother.           |
| <b>Excuses and attachments</b> | Field, oxen, and marriage are goods; they become refusals when treated as ultimate. This is a classic patristic reading of ordered love. |
| <b>Fear and love</b>           | The Collect prevents two errors: servile terror that avoids the table, and casual presumption that ignores the summons.                  |
| <b>Church and mission</b>      | The servant who announces supper is an image of apostolic preaching: the Church compels by truth, beauty, mercy, and urgency.            |
| <b>Prayer focus</b>            | Identify the respectable excuse that keeps charity theoretical, then answer the invitation through one concrete act of mercy.            |

## Preaching Applications

- Name modern excuses without contempt: busyness, family logistics, work, property, reputation, and curated comfort.
- Press the Eucharistic question: do I come to the Lord’s table while refusing the brother Christ has seated near me?
- Offer one concrete practice: before Sunday Mass, choose one act of hidden charity for someone who cannot repay it.

## Primary References

- Missale Romanum 1962, *Dominica Secunda post Pentecosten*.
- Suggested patristic study: Augustine on 1 John; Gregory the Great on Luke 14; Bede on the Gospel of Luke.

## Full Patristic and Sainly Texts

- St. Augustine, Homily 7 on First John: “Once for all, then, a short precept is given you: Love, and do what you will.”
- St. Augustine, Homily 7 on First John: “Let charity be there, and she fearlessly forgives, not being straitened.”